

ANCHORED IN PROGRESS: ADANI'S VIZHINJAM PORT MARKS FIRST YEAR WITH STRATEGIC MARITIME MILESTONES

With every TEU it handles, Vizhinjam is a bold bet on geography meeting ambition. The most strategically located maritime gateway is pulling out all stops to enhance India's connectivity, sovereignty, and standing in the global supply chain chessboard.

On a sun-drenched morning on June 9, as the towering silhouette of the MSC Irina— the world's largest container ship—edged into Vizhinjam's deep waters, India quietly rewrote the script of its maritime destiny. Stretching nearly 400 metres and capable of carrying over 24,000 containers, the Irina wasn't just another ship. It was a symbol—a declaration that India's long-standing dependence on foreign transshipment hubs might soon be history.

Welcome to Vizhinjam International Seaport, one of India's most advanced and strategically located maritime gateway. The port was dedicated to the nation by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on May 2.

Outsourcing India's transshipment: A thing of the past

For decades, over 75% of India's container cargo—especially from the south and west—was transshipped through foreign ports like Colombo (Sri Lanka), Singapore, Jebel Ali (Dubai, the UAE).

> **"On one hand there is this big sea with so many opportunities and on the other hand, there is beauty of nature… amidst all this, there is this Vizhinjam deep-water seaport, a symbol of new-age development."**
>
> Prime Minister, Narendra Modi



MSC Irina is the world's largest container vessel to berth at an Indian port. The ship reached Vizhinjam port on June 9.

This meant that Indian cargo—exports and imports alike—made a detour, increasing transit times, shipping costs and dependency on foreign infrastructure.

A dream anchored in geography

Tucked at the southern tip of the Indian peninsula in Kerala, Vizhinjam sits barely 10 nautical miles off the busiest east-west global shipping lanes. First conceived as a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) and backed by an over ₹10,000-crore investment from the Government of Kerala, Government of India, and the Adani Group, Vizhinjam is a bold bet on geography meeting ambition.

Steel, sea and smart technology

But Vizhinjam is more than location. It's engineering brilliance carved into the coastline.

With a natural depth of 24 metres, it is the only Indian port where Ultra Large Container Vessels can dock without continuous dredging—a costly, environmentally taxing necessity elsewhere. The port's backbone is its 2.96 km breakwater—the deepest in the country—protecting its 800-metre container berth, soon to be extended by another 1,200 metres.